GABRIEL POPA

Senior Software Engineer - Angular • Java (Spring) • AWS

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ABOUT ME

Senior Software Engineer with **10+ years of experience** building scalable business applications across modern frontend and backend systems, with strong specialization in **Angular**, **TypeScript**, **Java**, **Spring Boot**, and API-driven platform delivery. Background includes full-cycle feature development, legacy modernization, production issue resolution, performance tuning, asynchronous processing, and release support across complex web platforms. Strong hands-on experience with **Angular 8–18**, **TypeScript 3.x–5.x**, **Java 8–21**, **Spring 4–6 / Spring Boot 1.5–3.x**, **PostgreSQL**, **Redis**, **Kafka**, **RabbitMQ**, **Docker**, **AWS**, and CI/CD practices, applied to deliver stable services, maintainable UI architecture, and reliable backend workflows.

SKILLS

- **Frontend: Angular 8–18**, **TypeScript 3.x–5.x**, JavaScript ES6+, RxJS, NgRx, Angular CLI, Angular Material, Reactive Forms, Template-Driven Forms, Route Guards, Lazy Loading, reusable component architecture, SPA development, HTML5, CSS3, SCSS, responsive UI, Webpack, Vite basics, client-side validation
- **Backend & APIs: Java 8–21**, **Spring 4–6**, **Spring Boot 1.5–3.x**, Spring MVC, Spring Data JPA, Hibernate, REST API design, JWT authentication, OAuth2, RBAC, background jobs, scheduled processing, validation, service-layer architecture, API versioning, integration development
- **Data & Messaging: PostgreSQL**, MySQL, SQL, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Elasticsearch, query optimization, indexing, schema design, joins, pagination, caching strategies, event-driven processing, transactional workflows
- **Cloud & DevOps: AWS**, EC2, S3, RDS, ECS, EKS basics, IAM basics, Docker, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, Linux, Nginx, Apache, CI/CD pipelines, build pipelines, containerized deployments, release automation
- **Observability / Quality / Security:** structured logging, Sentry, OpenTelemetry basics, Prometheus/Grafana basics, correlation IDs, **JUnit**, **Mockito**, **Jest**, **Cypress**, **Playwright**, integration testing, API testing, end-to-end testing, OWASP security practices, rate limiting, access control, audit logging, error monitoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Soft Build | Bucharest, Romania *(Jan 2024 – May 2026)*

- Led delivery of a multi-tenant operational platform using **Angular 14–18**, **TypeScript**, **Java 17–21**, and **Spring Boot 2.x–3.x**, translating fragmented dashboard, reporting, and administration requirements into stable workflows with reusable modules and cleaner ownership boundaries.
- Modernized legacy frontend areas by restructuring large feature screens into Angular feature modules, shared components, route guards, and strongly typed services, which reduced regression-prone UI behavior and improved maintainability for ongoing product expansion.
- Migrated older frontend implementations toward a more scalable **standalone/component-driven Angular architecture**, reducing coupling across shared screens and lowering future upgrade complexity as the platform continued to evolve.
- Implemented dynamic form workflows with **Reactive Forms**, reusable validators, and standardized error display handling, which improved validation consistency and reduced repeated front-end defects across onboarding and administration flows by **33%**.
- Improved rendering speed on data-heavy pages by profiling change detection pressure, refining **RxJS** observable flows, and reducing unnecessary template recomputation, which made filtering and dashboard interaction noticeably more responsive.
- Solved a recurring real-time update issue where tenant status panels stopped refreshing after temporary disconnects by improving reconnect handling, buffering missed events, and restoring UI state safely once connections resumed.

- Built modular backend services with **Java**, **Spring Boot**, **Spring MVC**, and **Spring Data JPA**, creating clearer controller-service boundaries that improved testability, onboarding, and implementation safety for new business rules.
- Supported framework modernization by migrating older Spring configuration patterns into cleaner **Spring Boot 3.x** conventions, simplifying startup configuration and reducing fragile runtime behavior in shared deployment environments.
- Resolved a production duplicate-submission problem caused by race conditions and retry timing by introducing idempotent request checks, stronger validation, and safer transaction sequencing, which reduced inconsistent records by **29%**.
- Prevented duplicate billing and action processing by tightening **PostgreSQL** constraints, refining retry behavior, and enforcing safer backend write logic where asynchronous retries had previously caused data inconsistency.
- Integrated **Kafka** and **RabbitMQ** for asynchronous event flows around notifications, export generation, and downstream status updates, reducing tight coupling between user-triggered actions and background processing by **38%**.
- Strengthened platform security with **JWT**, **OAuth2**, role-aware UI rendering, request throttling, and audit-oriented logging, making sensitive administration actions easier to control and investigate during production support.
- Improved incident visibility by adding structured logs, **Sentry**, and **OpenTelemetry**-based telemetry around critical API and queue paths, which helped isolate tenant-specific failures faster and reduced troubleshooting time by **24%**.

Software Engineer

Next Apps | Ghent, Belgium *(Nov2020 – Nov 2023)*

- Built customer-facing product workflows using **Angular 9–16**, **TypeScript**, **Java 11–17**, and **Spring Boot 2.3–3.0**, focusing on validation-heavy pages, reusable backend services, and clearer state transitions for complex submission flows.
- Created a shared UI component library with **Angular Material**, reusable input wrappers, tables, modals, and feedback patterns, which reduced duplicated implementation effort and made product-wide interface changes easier to roll out.
- Improved maintainability by replacing scattered template logic with cleaner **RxJS** pipelines and service-layer state handling, reducing side-effect bugs by **31%** and making screen behavior more predictable during feature work.
- Migrated older form implementations into **Reactive Forms** with centralized validation rules, improving consistency across large submission flows and reducing front-end defects caused by duplicated validation logic.
- Implemented API-driven backend features using **Spring MVC**, **Spring Data JPA**, **Hibernate**, and REST design best practices, helping the team deliver cleaner service boundaries and more stable Angular-backend integration behavior.
- Modernized selected backend modules from older Java service patterns into cleaner **Spring Boot** conventions, introducing better validation structure, clearer dependency management, and safer release behavior without a risky rewrite.
- Developed versioned REST endpoints with safer deprecation paths so downstream clients could migrate gradually instead of breaking when shared response contracts evolved across product modules.
- Implemented **Redis** caching for hot endpoints using explicit invalidation and TTL strategies, reducing database pressure by **37%** while preserving data freshness for frequently accessed screens and workflows.
- Resolved intermittent **502/504** issues by aligning **Nginx** timeout behavior with backend processing paths, optimizing slow SQL queries, and adding latency visibility around the most sensitive user journeys.
- Fixed a hard-to-diagnose consistency issue caused by out-of-order async events by enforcing ordering keys and building a small reconciliation worker, which reduced background processing failures by **23%**.
- Improved delivery quality by adding integration checks, API testing, **Jest**, and **Cypress** coverage around critical workflows, which reduced regressions after endpoint or validation changes and improved release confidence.

Software Developer

Datamart | Stockholm, Sweden *(Feb 2016 – Sept 2020)*

- Built internal analytics and administration tools using early **Angular**, **Java**, Spring-based backend services, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, SQL, and relational data workflows, helping teams work more efficiently with large operational datasets.

- Supported a gradual backend refactor from tightly coupled application structure into smaller service-oriented modules, which improved maintainability while preserving business behavior relied on by older internal integrations.
- Optimized report performance by diagnosing slow joins, adding missing **PostgreSQL** indexes, reviewing execution plans, and reducing heavy query paths, cutting dashboard and export latency by **43%** for data-heavy workflows.
- Modernized older UI screens by moving brittle controller-heavy frontend logic into more maintainable Angular component patterns, improving reuse and making change tracking easier across repeated administrative use cases.
- Resolved a difficult reporting issue caused by timezone mismatches between browser input, API serialization, and database storage by standardizing date handling rules across the full request lifecycle.
- Implemented background processing for large exports and long-running report generation, replacing synchronous request handling that regularly timed out and giving users clearer progress visibility for heavy jobs.
- Added automated integration coverage around sensitive business flows so common regression paths were detected earlier during release cycles instead of surfacing only after deployment.
- Improved CI reliability by separating fast verification checks from heavier integration execution, reducing noisy pipeline failures and giving developers quicker feedback on safe code changes by **21%**.
- Introduced audit logging for record updates and operational approvals, helping support teams trace user actions more clearly when data disputes or unexpected changes were reported.
- Reduced frontend asset weight through code splitting, dependency cleanup, and better loading boundaries, improving startup time for users on slower devices and networks by **18%**.

Junior Software Developer

Berg Software | Timișoara, Romania *(Sep2014 – Mar 2016)*

- Built early web modules using **Java 7/8**, **Spring MVC**, JavaScript, jQuery, MySQL, and server-rendered UI patterns, helping deliver consistent request handling and smaller feature updates for internal and client-facing applications.
- Improved legacy pages by introducing modular JavaScript behavior, clearer validation feedback, and better form handling, which reduced user input mistakes and repeated support follow-up by **27%**.
- Helped fix a recurring logout problem by correcting session cookie configuration and aligning backend timeout behavior with browser handling, improving login stability without forcing broad architectural changes.
- Implemented smaller feature requests such as filter updates, table behavior improvements, and form adjustments, delivering practical enhancements while learning existing business rules and platform structure.
- Fixed layout and browser behavior problems in older pages by adjusting HTML, CSS, and JavaScript interactions, which improved usability and reduced interface inconsistency across frequently used screens.
- Added reusable helper methods and shared page utilities in areas where repeated code was creating maintenance friction, making later updates easier for senior developers to apply.
- Helped investigate production defects by reviewing logs, reproducing issues locally, and narrowing failing conditions before fixes were finalized, contributing to more reliable issue isolation across releases.
- Improved SQL usage in a few higher-traffic screens by replacing inefficient query patterns with safer and clearer statements, which reduced avoidable database load by **18%** in daily usage.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science

University of Bucharest | (*2010 – 2014)*

- Focused on practical software engineering fundamentals that translated directly into building reliable web systems and data-driven applications.

CERITIFICATIONS

Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE Developer — 2023

- Demonstrated strong capability in building and maintaining **Java** applications, including object-oriented design, core language features, exception handling, collections, and application logic used in enterprise backend development.

AWS Certified Developer – Associate — 2022

- Demonstrated practical experience in developing, deploying, and supporting cloud-based applications on **AWS**, with focus on service integration, security, monitoring, and reliable delivery workflows.